

Illustration by GAURAV SARJERAO

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N. CHANDRASEKARAN, 59

CHAIRMAN, TATA SONS

CONSOLIDATOR-IN-CHIEF

BECAUSE "the first non-Parsi and professional executive to head the Tata Group", the amiable and confident Chandrasekaran is transforming the $128 bn (Rs 10.6 lakh crore) salt-to-software conglomerate. Coup de grace: a year after it bought the beleaguered Air India, the Tatas ordered 470 new planes from Airbus and Boeing in February for $70 bn (Rs 5.7 lakh crore), per listed prices, the biggest such purchase in aviation history

BECAUSE it's also eyeing a whole array of emerging opportunities, including aircraft manufacturing, defence, FMCG, electronics and semiconductors, payments, battery-making and storage solutions, 5G technology and infrastructure and hyperloop technology. Not to speak of the Tata Neu SuperApp

BECAUSE after consolidating 100-odd companies under 30 large ones across 10 verticals, the group already employs over 935,000 people. The consolidated revenue of Rs 9.6 lakh crore in FY22 could well be the envy of many a national economy

LONG-DISTANCE RUNNER
Chandra's day starts at 4 am with a daily run, an activity he took up in 2008 to ward off diabetes. He now tots up as many as four marathons in a year and plans to run an ultra marathon of 60 km when he turns 60

PET PROJECT The renovated Bombay House has an AC kennel for stray dogs, complete with warm dog beds, toys, food and fresh water, in deference to the former chairman's love for man's best friend